FICTIONAL TRAINING ARTIFACT — NOT FILED — NOT LEGAL ADVICE

Anti-retaliation policy: purpose and coverage

Blue Cedar prohibits adverse action because an employee reports suspected discrimination, opposes a practice reasonably believed discriminatory, files a charge, supplies information, or participates in an investigation. Protection applies whether the concern is raised internally or with an agency.

Managers may address legitimate performance, conduct, or business needs, but they must not allow protected activity to influence timing, criteria, scoring, selection, or explanation. Human resources must review a proposed termination involving a recent complainant and identify the business record supporting the decision.

This policy creates an internal control. It does not decide whether any particular employment action violates law.

Reporting and participation protections

Employees may report concerns to a supervisor, human resources, the compliance mailbox, or an external agency. No special words or form are required internally. The recipient must record the date, subject, requested review, and persons informed.

An employee may supply documents, attend an interview, or assist another employee without interference. Managers may not discourage an agency charge, condition workplace access on withdrawal, or seek the contents of a confidential interview except through lawful process.

Human resources assigns a tracking reference and limits distribution to people with a defined need to know. The log must retain each transfer and acknowledgment.

Manager escalation and noninterference

A manager receiving a discrimination concern must forward it to human resources within one business day. The manager must preserve assignment, review, compensation, and messaging records and may not revise them outside the ordinary system.

For ninety days after notice of protected activity, human resources reviews any proposed change to the employee's role, score, pay, schedule, or employment. The review records the decisionmaker, criteria, contemporaneous documents, and any comparable employees considered.

The policy does not impose a moratorium on genuine restructuring. It requires traceable reasons and consistent application while preventing the complaint from becoming a negative factor.

February 14 RIF authorization appended to the January policy

A reduction in force begins with a written finance target, covered population, expected effective date, and accountable operations executive. In the authorization appended on February 14, Sable Finch set a $612,000 annualized payroll target for the 2025 exercise and designated Draven Pike as accountable executive.

Operations may group positions only when their principal duties materially overlap. The initial workbook must show all employees in the group before exclusions or selections. Human resources maintains a read-only baseline and a version history.

No employee-relations status may be entered as a scoring field. Recent protected activity is flagged solely for the separate anti-retaliation review.

Defined criteria and weights

The protocol assigns thirty points to audit completion, twenty-five to client continuity, fifteen to credentials, fifteen to cross-region availability, and fifteen to role uniqueness. Higher totals favor retention. Source data must identify its reporting period.

Completion measures timely closure of assigned audits, excluding delays documented as client-controlled. Continuity measures near-term disruption from reassignment. Credentials include active qualifications actually used. Availability considers completed and accepted travel, not unsupported impressions. Role uniqueness measures functions not reasonably transferable within ninety days.

The five weights total one hundred. A later adjustment must state the old value, new value, author, date, and cited basis.

Evidence and score validation

Human resources imports completion data from the audit tracker, continuity dates from engagement plans, credentials from the training register, and travel history from approved schedules. The employee's supervisor validates the source but may not alter the imported baseline.

Where a metric is disputed, the workbook links the underlying record and marks the cell for calibration. A narrative cannot replace a quantitative source without identifying why the source is unreliable.

Before selection, Solis must reconcile the workbook to personnel reviews and confirm that the same measurement window was used across the comparison group. Unresolved exceptions remain visible rather than being silently overwritten.

Manual adjustments and version history

Every manual change requires a reason code: corrected source data, documented client need, approved credential equivalence, verified availability change, or unique-function exception. Free-text explanation accompanies the code.

The version log records who made and approved the change. It must preserve the imported value and all intermediate values. Bulk copy operations are separately noted so that an accidental formula replacement can be reconstructed.

An adjustment cannot be justified solely by the desired savings scenario. Pike may reject a scenario, but a change to an employee score must rest on the defined criterion and evidence.

Comparator exceptions and approval

An exception favoring retention identifies the employee, concrete business need, expected duration, and why another member of the group cannot meet it. Client continuity expected to end before the RIF effective date receives no credit; later transitions use the same scale for every employee.

Travel and automation exceptions require documented history or a maintained function, not a manager's unrecorded preference. Human resources reviews comparable requests together.

Pike gives final written approval after Solis certifies consistent treatment. A rejected or expired exception remains in the version history and cannot be recast under a different label without a new explanation.

Selection, notice, and post-RIF audit

The final scenario lists selected positions, retained positions, annualized savings, coverage assignments, and the approval date. Termination notices state the contemporaneous business reason without adding unsupported performance criticism.

Within thirty days, human resources compares planned and actual duty redistribution, payroll savings, and use of approved exceptions. Material deviations go to the compliance committee. Records include the finance authorization, every workbook version, source metrics, minutes, approvals, notices, and the post-RIF organization chart.

These controls define the required records and review steps. The existence of a written control alone neither proves that it was followed nor determines whether a selection was retaliatory.